Said Meinerding, “Captain America’s costume has an unabashedly extreme quality to it. It’s red, white and blue, and proudly boasts stars and stripes. For those of us that love the character, that iconic, strong visual is part of what makes Cap so close to our hearts. We tried our hardest to keep that icon while allowing those not as familiar with the character to find him cool and appealing and not just shut down at the sight of such a powerfully poignant comic image. Relating his costume to a soldier’s gear was a big step, and trying to use materials that would feel advanced for the 1940s was another part of that.”

The film’s producers also struggled to capture Captain America’s essence as they hunted for the perfect actor to fill the iconic role. “If you look at our other films, you see that we cast performers first,” Co-Producer Stephen Broussard said. “We make sure that we cast actors with real talent, with real acting chops, and that’s certainly going to be the case with a character like Steve Rogers. It’s a very complex character. He starts in one place, ends up in a completely different place, both physically and emotionally. You need someone that can play the broad range of that. You also need someone that when we get to *The Avengers* can go toe-to-toe with actors like Robert Downey Jr., can hold their own in a scene.”



